

Some interesting tools worth a look

- **Cognoa Canvas Dx and Aignosis.** Easy-to-use apps for early screening, diagnosis, and detection of autism
- **SocialMind app.** Trains caregivers and therapists on strategies to motivate children with autism to talk and communicate
- **Empatica's EmbracePlus smartwatch and app.** Help anticipate and potentially prevent aggressive outbursts by warning caregivers on time
- **seamlessCARE's Empathic.** Helps interpret the emotions of non-verbal people
- **Proloquo2Go, TippyTalk, Avaz AAC, Jellow AAC, and QuickPic AAC.** Augmentative and alternative communication tools that help individuals with communication challenges
- **Otsimo and InnerVoice.** Help neurodivergent people to practice conversations and social interactions
- **NAO, Milo, Jibo and Kaspar.** Friendly robots that help neurodivergent individuals to practice and improve their social skills
- **Floreo VR.** Safe, customisable, and immersive VR platform to practice communication and social skills
- **Calm, Headspace, and Brain.fm.** Help individuals to relax and reduce anxiety using a combination of techniques like music, storytelling, and breathing exercises

controlled, and safe real-world environments for individuals to practice social skills, communication, and daily living activities. In the virtual world, individuals are even exposed to difficult situations in a controlled way, to teach them how to respond to such situations without getting anxious.

Floreo VR, for example, is a safe, customisable, and immersive VR platform that helps neurodivergent individuals of any age and ability to practice communication and social skills at their own pace. The team works closely with researchers and therapists to develop science-backed and evidence-based learning experiences.

Smart glasses. Smart glasses are a great tool for those with disabilities. They can give cues in real time to help understand more about the objects, people, and activities in the environment. Smart glasses can display real-time captions or sign language interpretation for those with hearing impairments; magnify content for those with low vision; help break down tasks into manageable steps or minimise sensory overload for neurodivergent learners; and integrate emotional

recognition tools to enable individuals with ASD to navigate social interactions.

For example, AR smart glasses integrated with the Affectiva emotion recognition SDK can help users identify emotions from facial expressions and body language. Neurotechnology company Brain Power uses AR smart glasses, AI, and emotion analytics technology to help individuals on the autism spectrum to teach themselves crucial socio-emotional skills, such as emotion recognition, eye contact, and self-control.

Tools that make every day better

There are a host of AI-powered tools out there that make daily life at home, at school, and at work much easier for neurodivergent people. They make the world seem safer, friendlier, and easier to navigate, while also helping to maintain a routine and break down tasks into smaller, manageable ones.

Wearable technologies. AI-equipped wearables can monitor physiological signals (like stress levels) and provide calming feedback or alert the caregiver

when required. Wearables can also provide essential cues to help individuals understand emotions and navigate through everyday social interactions. With alarms, lists, and reminders, they help maintain a routine and to complete tasks.

Smart home integration. When integrated with a smart home, wearable devices can adjust environmental settings like lighting, air-conditioning, or music to provide calming feedback. Smart gadgets, such as door locks or cooking ranges, can provide cues and reminders for safety and security aspects.

Relaxation. AI-powered apps like Calm, Headspace, and Brain.fm help individuals relax through various techniques, including controlled breathing, meditation, and music.

Task management. Tools like Google Calendar, Microsoft Outlook, Todoist, Trello, Sunsama, Notion, Evernote, and Reclaim.ai help manage time and tasks, with many accessible features like visual representation, colour-coding, and task breakdown.

Communications. Writing assistants like Grammarly and Hemingway Editor, transcription services like Otter and Rev, dictation software like Speechnotes and Dragon NaturallySpeaking, translators like Google Translate, reading aids like Microsoft Immersive Reader, text-to-speech converters like Speechify, mind-mapper MindMeister, and note-taking assistant Glean help people in the autistic spectrum to communicate more professionally at school, college, and work.

For the odd jobs. There are some AI tools and chatbots, which come in handy for this and that, and every other undefined task. Goblin Tools is an interesting platform that we see many neurodivergent people